Module 8: Prepare for the Implementation

Topic: Define the Scope of the Project

To define the scope of a management system, establish clear boundaries for where it will apply within the organization.

Key Points:

1. Define What is Included in the Scope

   a. Identify which parts of the organization will be covered.
   b. Specify the products, services, and markets to be included.

2. Full vs. Partial Scope

   a. The scope may cover the entire organization (all processes, products, and services) or only specific parts (e.g., certain locations or products).

3. Input for Defining the Scope

   b. Consider the budget, standards, legal requirements, top management's intention, and the current state of the organization.

4. Perform a Gap Analysis (Optional but Recommended)

   c. A gap analysis helps assess which parts of the management system are in place and which are missing.
   d. This allows for better planning, resource management, and a clearer understanding of the project's scope.

Key Stages of the Project

ISO management system standards follow the Plan-Do-Check-Act (PDCA) cycle. This cycle ensures an effective management system through logical stages of planning, implementation, evaluation, and improvement.

Key Stages:

1. Plan Phase

   a. Set the scope, objectives, and top-level policy.
   b. Establish the organizational structure and perform risk management.

2. Do Phase

   a. Implement the planned processes to achieve the objectives.

b. Focus on executing top-level policies through specific processes (e.g., production, environmental, or security processes depending on the management system).

3. Check Phase

a. Monitor and measure performance.
b. Conduct internal audits and management reviews to evaluate progress.

4. Act Phase

a. Address non-conformities and develop corrective actions.
b. Focus on continual improvement of the management system.

Tips for Project Management

To manage a project effectively, it's essential to define tasks, control execution, and monitor progress. Here's how to approach it:

Key Points:

1. Define Tasks and Schedule

a. Use the GAP analysis and PDCA cycle to list activities needed for management system implementation.
b. Consider the organization's resources, your time, and deadlines.
c. Prioritize tasks and create a calendar outlining what needs to be done, by whom, and when.

2. Include Control Points

a. Set control points in the calendar to monitor progress, ensure the plan is on track, and identify any necessary management actions.

3. Monitor Progress and Quality

b. Continuously check the project's progress, quality, and how well it's being followed.
c. Monitor effectiveness to ensure the project's objectives are being met.

4. Final Verification

a. Before certification, schedule a final review to ensure everything has been properly prepared from the start of the project.

5. Control Points and Milestones

b. Create control points for key milestones like policy awareness, procedural implementation, and performance monitoring.

6. Meetings for Evaluation

   c. Plan regular meetings with the team and project sponsor for ongoing evaluation and feedback.

Estimating the Project

The duration of implementation depends on the size of the organization and the availability of resources.

Key Points:

1. Project Duration by Organization Size

   d. Small organizations (up to 50 employees): Typically less than 8 months.
   e. Midsize organizations (up to 500 employees): Usually 8 to 12 months.
   f. Large organizations (500+ employees): Typically 12 to 15 months.

2. Avoid Extended Timelines

   a. Be cautious if smaller organizations exceed 12 months—such projects are often never completed.

3. Estimate Workload

   a. Consider the team's size, experience, authority, and availability.
   b. Factor in your own availability for project delivery based on the duration requirements.

4. Work Discipline

   a. For longer projects (e.g., 12 months), aim for at least 1 dedicated day per week during the initial phase to ensure consistent progress.

5. Engage Team Members

   b. Ensure that the project is treated as a priority and not as a side task to promote focus and completion.

Communication in Project Management

Effective communication is critical for project success, ensuring everyone understands their role and the project's progress.

Key Points:

1. Communicate the Project’s Purpose

   c. Clearly explain the project’s goal, its importance, and how others can contribute to the implementation.

2. Communication with the Project Team

   d. A project is a temporary organization, and communication is essential to hold everything together and avoid conflicts.

3. Questions to Address

   e. Who needs to know?
   f. What do they need to know?
   g. How much do they need to know?
   h. How often should they be informed?

4. Feedback on Progress

   i. Regular feedback is essential for tracking:
   j. Current progress.
   k. Problems encountered and anticipated.
   l. Technical difficulties.

5. Status Reports

   m. Stakeholders expect regular reports. Reports should include:
   n. Completed tasks.
   o. Incomplete tasks and reasons.
   p. Unresolved issues and future plans.
   q. Anticipated difficulties.

6. Organize with a Calendar

   r. Create a calendar outlining tasks, deadlines, and responsible team members.
   s. Organize key stages chronologically and note which tasks must be done in parallel or sequentially.

7. Allocate Responsibilities

   t. Ensure each key stage is owned by a team member to promote accountability.

Tools for Management System Implementation

When starting a management system implementation, the right tools can simplify the process and improve efficiency.

Key Points:

1. Project Management & Collaboration Tools

   u. Help manage tasks, communicate with team members, and streamline change control without relying on excessive emails.

2. Flowchart Tools

   v. Speed up the development of flowcharts for documentation and process mapping.

3. Skype

   w. A simple tool for virtual meetings, enabling team members to communicate and share screens online.

4. Performance Monitoring Tools

   x. Use charts and dashboards to track organizational performance and project evolution, instead of just looking at numbers in tables.

5. Legislation Monitoring Software

   y. Track changes in legal standards relevant to your management system to stay updated effortlessly.

6. Documentation Writing Tools

   z. Use templates and tutorials to speed up the development of policies and procedures. Look for tools that provide guidelines and support.

7. Pros and Cons of Automation Tools

   Pros:

   aa. Eliminate time-consuming tasks, such as risk assessments.

   bb. Merge results and suggest steps for the project, including who's responsible for what.

   Cons:

   cc. Often designed for larger companies with complex features and higher costs.

   dd. Time-consuming training may be required for employees.

8. Choosing the Right Documentation Templates

ee. Ensure templates are suitable for your company's size.
ff. Check if they include helpful guidelines or tutorials.
gg. Choose templates created by authors with experience in both consulting and auditing.

Choosing the right tools can accelerate the implementation process and make ongoing system maintenance more manageable.

Roles and Responsibilities Overview:

1. Project Sponsor:
    a. Unlocks resources.
    b. Resolves conflicting priorities.
    c. Addresses escalated issues.
2. Project Manager:
    a. Ensures necessary resources for implementation.
    b. Coordinates project activities.
    c. Provides progress updates to the sponsor.
    d. Oversees administrative tasks.
    e. Ensures project timelines are met with adequate authority.
3. Project Team:
    a. Assists in project implementation.
    b. Executes tasks outlined in the project plan.
    c. Involved in decision-making on multidisciplinary issues.
    d. Reviews project documents before finalization.
    e. Attends meetings as deemed necessary by the Project Manager.

Best Practice for Consultants:

a. Identify each participant's role in the project plan.
b. Define how they access project information.
c. Establish clear communication flow to and from participants.

4. Project Communication:
    a. Ensure all participants have access to relevant project information.

b. Define the communication channels between the Project Manager, Sponsor, and Project Team.
c. Set regular updates and status reports to keep all parties informed.

5. Intervention when Project is Halted:

a. Project Sponsor steps in to resolve issues halting the project.
b. Sponsor's intervention includes addressing resource constraints or conflicting priorities.
c. The Project Manager communicates the issue and facilitates a resolution with the Sponsor's guidance.

<u>Project Manager Risk Management Overview:</u>

1. Risk Management:

a. Identify, categorize, prioritize, and plan for risks before they become issues.
b. Be proactive, not just reactive.

2. Common Risks:

a. Lack of support or communication from top management.
b. Missed activities in the initial scope.
c. Inaccurate time or cost estimates.
d. Resource shortages or inexperienced team members.
e. Data protection and confidentiality issues.

3. Ongoing Risk Assessment:

a. Risk management should be continuous throughout the project lifecycle, not a one-time task.

<u>Project Documentation Overview:</u>

1. Importance of Documentation:

b. Records all project data and changes for future reference.
c. Helps manage the project effectively by serving as a knowledge source.

2. Organizing Project Files:

a. Create folders for different project stages (e.g., Project Plans, Schedules).

b. Keep updated plans and previous versions accessible.
c. Ensure team members are aware of their responsibilities and changes in the plan.

3. Project Execution Records:

a. Keep track of how the project progressed and what was delivered.
b. Document meeting agendas, deliverables, versions, and the implementation plan.

4. Project Control Records:

a. Maintain evidence of monitoring, control, and decisions made during the project.
b. Documentation helps resolve conflicts and misunderstandings later.

5. Project Status Reports:

a. Record agendas and control meeting decisions.
b. Keep status reports up-to-date to show progress.

6. Project End:

a. Record the final meeting with top management, confirming project completion.
b. Include decisions on whether to proceed with certification.

7. Protective Measure:

a. Documentation serves as protection against accusations or legal issues, proving the decisions made and actions taken.

<u>Project Plan Overview:</u>

1. Project Context:

b. Define services to be provided.
c. List expected outcomes.
d. Detail deliverables.
e. Set conditions for final closure and acceptance.

2. Risks and Constraints:

a. Identify potential risks that could affect success or duration.
b. Note any constraints limiting project resources, time, or scope.

3. Methodology and Work Plan:

a. Describe how the project will be performed, managed, and communicated.
b. Include:

c. Methodology to follow.
d. Required technological resources.
e. Project organization structure.
f. Human resources needed and their responsibilities.
g. Timetable and milestones.
h. Project management methods and progress evaluation.
i. Communication channels and reporting structure.
j. Any knowledge transfers during the project.

4. Roles and Responsibilities:

a. Specify roles of all participants.
b. Designate a project sponsor for governance

Kick-off Meeting Overview:

1. Purpose:

a. Communicate project importance to the company.
b. Define each person’s role and contribution.
c. Present the project timeline and key milestones.

2. Role of Project Sponsor:

a. Chair and open the meeting.
b. Explain the strategic context and urgency of the project.
c. Highlight its priority compared to other projects and daily operations.